

FREE GUIDE



The Complete Type 4 Wash Day Checklist

Every step, in order — so wash day finally feels simple.

by Schicgirl



Your Wash Day, In Order

Let's make wash day feel calm and clear. Once it becomes a simple sequence, the overwhelm fades — follow these seven steps in the order that suits your hair, print the sheet, and tick as you go.

THE 7 STEPS 1 Pre-wash → 2 Cleanse → 3 Deep condition → 4 Detangle → 5 Moisturise
→ 6 Style → 7 Protect

1 • PRE-WASH CHECKLIST

- ☐ Detangle gently on dry or oiled hair to reduce shedding
- ☐ Apply a pre-poo (oil or conditioner) to the lengths and ends
- ☐ Section hair into 4–6 twists to stay organised
- ☐ Optional: warm oil or a scalp massage to loosen buildup
- ☐ Set out all products and tools *before* you start

SCHICGIRL TIP

Pre-wash is where wash day is won. Detangling and pre-pooing on dry hair protects your length and makes every step that follows faster and gentler.

Cleanse & Deep Condition



2 • CLEANSING CHECKLIST

- ☐ Rinse with warm — not hot — water to open the cuticle
- ☐ Shampoo the scalp in sections; co-wash the lengths if dry
- ☐ Massage with fingertips, never nails
- ☐ Clarify every 2–4 weeks, or whenever there's noticeable buildup
- ☐ Rinse thoroughly — leave no residue behind

3 • DEEP CONDITIONING CHECKLIST

- ☐ Apply section by section on damp hair, roots to ends
- ☐ Concentrate the most product on your ends
- ☐ Cover with a cap; add gentle heat for low porosity (20–40 min)
- ☐ Use a moisture deep-conditioner most weeks; reach for a light protein treatment only if your hair feels weak, overly stretchy, or is breaking
- ☐ Rinse with cool water to seal the cuticle

Detangle & Moisturise



4 • DETANGLING CHECKLIST

- ☐ Detangle on slip — conditioner or water still in the hair
- ☐ Work in sections, from the **ends up** to the roots
- ☐ Fingers first, then a wide-tooth comb
- ☐ Take extra care at the nape and crown
- ☐ Re-twist each finished section to keep it tangle-free

5 • MOISTURISING CHECKLIST

- ☐ Start on damp hair with water or a water-based leave-in (L)
- ☐ Layer in the order your hair likes — many prefer **LCO** for low porosity and **LOC** for high, but test both and trust your results
- ☐ Smooth product down the shaft, then scrunch into the ends
- ☐ Seal the ends extra — they're the oldest and driest
- ☐ Keep layers light — don't overload

SCHICGIRL REMINDER

If you're ever unsure where to focus your care, choose your **ends**. They're the oldest, most fragile part of your hair — and they often decide how much length you keep.

Style & Protect



6 • STYLING CHECKLIST

- ☐ Style on damp — not soaking — hair for definition
- ☐ Choose a styler for your hold: gel, cream, or custard
- ☐ Smooth, then rake or shingle for clumped curls
- ☐ Air-dry or diffuse on low; don't touch while drying
- ☐ Let it set fully before fluffing or separating

7 • NIGHT PROTECTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Pineapple, or loosely band longer hair
- ☐ Satin bonnet or scarf — or a satin pillowcase
- ☐ Re-moisturise only dry spots with a light mist
- ☐ Avoid cotton — it drinks your moisture overnight
- ☐ Refresh in the morning with water + a little oil



Wash Day at a Glance

Print this page and keep it where you wash — your whole routine in seven moves.

- 1 **Pre-wash** — detangle, pre-poo, section
- 2 **Cleanse** — wash the scalp, rinse well
- 3 **Deep condition** — moisture (+ heat if low porosity)
- 4 **Detangle** — on slip, ends to roots
- 5 **Moisturise** — water first, then layer (LCO or LOC — test both)
- 6 **Style** — damp hair, define, dry undisturbed
- 7 **Protect** — satin overnight, refresh in the morning

THE 3 NON-NEGOTIABLES

- ✓ Deep conditioning
- ✓ Moisturising on damp hair
- ✓ Satin protection at night

Keep only these three consistent and your Type 4 hair will usually stay healthier, softer, and easier to manage.

FROM WASH DAY TO FULL ROUTINE

If this made wash day simpler, *Hydrated — The Complete Type 4 Hydration Handbook* expands every step into a complete system: frameworks, recipes, troubleshooting and worksheets.

[Discover Hydrated →](#)

“A calm wash day is a kept promise to your crown.”

SCHICGIRL WISDOM

CONTINUE YOUR HAIR JOURNEY

Ready for the Next Step?

You've mastered the perfect wash day. The next step is turning that single ritual into lasting momentum.

This program guides you day by day — the rhythm where real, visible progress is actually made.

RECOMMENDED NEXT RESOURCE

The 30-Day Hair Growth Program

Turn one good wash day into 30 days of momentum, with a guided routine that protects length and builds healthy hair habits.

If you enjoyed this guide and want a complete step-by-step system, this resource was created for you.

INSIDE YOU'LL DISCOVER

- ✓ A day-by-day plan that builds your routine into a lasting habit
- ✓ How to protect length and minimise breakage between wash days
- ✓ Scalp care and gentle handling that support healthy growth
- ✓ Simple trackers to watch your progress over the month
- ✓ The consistency framework that turns effort into retained length

Who it's for: Anyone ready to go beyond a single wash day and build a routine that lasts.

If your wash day now feels effortless, this is how you build a whole month of momentum.

AVAILABLE AT sclar.com/m/schicgirl

*You've already taken the most important step — choosing to understand your hair.
We'll be here for every step that follows.*

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